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Introduction to Business Frameworks
Session - 7

9th October, 2026

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Agenda

1 STP & 4Ps

2 Growth



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STP - Segmentation, Targeting & Positioning

The strategic core of modern marketing: decide who you serve, then how you want to be seen by them.

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Segmentation I Split a broad market into groups of customers with similar needs or behaviours.

Basis	Description	Example
Demographic	Age, income, gender, family size	Premium credit cards for high-income professionals
Geographic	Region, climate, urban/rural	Tata Tea's regional blends for different state tastes
Psychographic	Lifestyle, values, personality	Fabindia for culturally conscious, craft-valuing buyers
Behavioural	Usage, loyalty, occasion, benefits sought	Quick-commerce apps serving "urgent need" vs "planned stock-up" shoppers

Good segments are: measurable, substantial, accessible via channels, and differentiable (respond differently to marketing).

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Targeting, Positioning and Putting It Together I Choosing where to compete & owning a place in the customer's mind

- Targeting: Evaluate each segment on size and growth, competitive intensity, and fit with company strengths. Then pick a strategy:
  - Undifferentiated: one offer for all (e.g., basic commodity salt)
  - Differentiated: separate offers per segment (e.g., Maruti Suzuki: Alto for first-time buyers, Brezza for urban families, Nexa for premium buyers)
  - Concentrated/niche: go deep on one segment (e.g., Lamborghini, or Mamaearth's early focus on toxin-free baby care)
- Positioning: Define how you want the target segment to perceive you relative to competitors. A positioning statement:
  - For [target customer], [brand] is the [category] that [key benefit] because [reason to believe].
  - Apple: premium, design-led, simple technology for creative, status-conscious users
  - Instamart?

The 4Ps: the controllable levers a firm uses to deliver its positioning to the target segment

STP tells you where to play; the 4Ps tell you how to win there.

P	Core question	Key decisions	Example
Product	What are we offering?	Features, quality, design, branding, packaging, range, after-sales service	**Apple:** tightly integrated hardware, software and design; the product *is* the brand experience
Price	What is it worth to the customer?	List price, discounts, payment terms, pricing strategy (premium, penetration, skimming, value-based)	**Jio:** penetration pricing with free and cheap data to win mass adoption fast
Place	How and where does the customer get it?	Distribution channels, coverage, logistics, inventory, online vs offline	**Amul:** cold chain and a vast retailer network making fresh dairy available nationwide
Promotion	How do we communicate and persuade?	Advertising, PR, sales promotion, digital and social media, influencers, personal selling	**Dove:** the “Real Beauty” campaign building emotional connection and brand meaning

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In-class case 1

We want to start a cloud-kitchen that serves lunch via a subscription service to tech parks via large parcels containing 100 lunch boxes to a tech park and distributes it there to its subscribers

Define STP, 4Ps & GTM for us

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In-class case 2

You want to start offering short, online, weekend-based courses for working professionals (Excel, AI, etc.) in small cohorts, with live instructors and practical projects.

Should we target fresh graduates, 2–5 year experienced professionals, or mid-career managers—and should it compete on price, outcomes, convenience or instructor quality?


Q&A